Magnesium Citrate + Bisacodyl

Colonoscopy prep · Kurt Vernon, MD, PA

Buy at the Pharmacy

- ✓ 2 bottles of magnesium citrate (over the counter, about $8–10)
- ✓ 1 bottle of bisacodyl 5 mg tablets, 10 count (over the counter, about $3–5)

Before Your Prep Day

1. Tell your physician if you take blood-thinning medications such as warfarin, clopidogrel, apixaban, dabigatran, enoxaparin or aspirin. You may be asked to stop them 3 to 7 days before your procedure, if your family physician or cardiologist approves.

The Day Before

1. No more solid food. Only clear liquids for the whole day.
2. At 5:00 pm, drink one bottle of magnesium citrate, followed by three 8 oz glasses (24 oz) of any clear liquid. Also take 5 bisacodyl tablets. This part of the prep takes about 1 hour.
3. Stay close to a bathroom.
4. Stay very well hydrated. Drink extra clear liquids before you go to bed.

The Day of Your Colonoscopy

1. Beginning at 11:00 pm, drink the second bottle of magnesium citrate, followed by three 8 oz glasses (24 oz) of any clear liquid. This part of the prep takes about 1 hour.
2. Do not eat anything.
3. Do not drink anything for 3 hours before your procedure.
4. If you take medications, you may take essential medications (for blood pressure, heart or seizures) the morning of the procedure with a small sip of water.
5. If you are diabetic, do not take your oral diabetes medicines the morning of the procedure. If you take injectable insulin, take half of your morning dose. Procedures are canceled if your blood sugar is over 300.
6. Arrive at the facility at the time the office gave you.

Clear Liquids You Can Have

No milk or milk products (including non-dairy creamer), and nothing red, blue or purple.

- Water
- Soft drinks, including colas
- Coffee or tea, without milk, cream or creamer
- Sports drinks (green or yellow)
- Gelatin (green or yellow)
- Ice pops (green or yellow)
- Hard candy
- Chicken or beef broth or bouillon (no vegetables)
- Apple juice, white grape juice or other strained fruit juice

---

Take all of the medication and liquids so Dr. Vernon can see your entire colon clearly.

A colonoscopy prep makes your body lose a lot of fluid, which can make you ill (dehydration). Drink extra clear liquids before the prep, stay hydrated with clear liquids during the prep as directed, and drink clear liquids after you get home.

Questions about your prep? Call Fuquay-Varina at (919) 577-0085 or Dunn at (910) 891-5808, Monday – Thursday, 8:30 am – 5:00 pm.

